

CATEGORY

LOW-END AMD MOTHERBOARDS

Brand	AOpen	DFI	ASUS	Gigabyte	Gigabyte	Jetway
Model	MK77M II	AZ 30-TL	A7V8X-MX	7VKM-P	GA- 7VM400M	V4MDMP
Chipset	VIA KM266	VIA KM266	VIA KM400	VIA KT400	VIA KM400	VIA KM400
Interface type	Socket A	Socket A	Socket A	Socket A	Socket A	Socket A
Maximum CPU supported	Athlon XP 2400+	Athlon XP 2400+	Athlon XP 2800+	Athlon XP 2400+	Athlon XP 2800+	Athlon XP 2800+
Memory speed (MHz) / Max memory (GB) / Memory slots	266 / 2 / 2	266 / 2 / 2	333 / 2 / 2	266 / 2 / 2	333 / 2 / 2	333 / 2 / 2
Form factor	Mini ATX	Mini ATX	Mini ATX	Mini ATX	Mini ATX	MiniATX
AGP port/ Onboard AGP / Type	✓ / ✓ / 4X	✓ / ✓ / 4X	✓ / ✓ / 8X	✓ / ✓ / 4X	✓ / ✓ / 8X	✓ / ✓ / 8X
PCI slots	3	3	3	3	3	3
Onboard sound / Built in APU	✓ / ✗	✓ / ✗	✓ / ✗	✓ / ✗	✓ / ✗	✓ / ✗
USB ports / Rear / Ports via cable	6 / 2 / 4	6 / 2 / 4	6 / 4 / 2	6 / 2 / 4	6 / 2 / 4	6 / 2 / 4
Ethernet	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Overclocking and BIOS updating features / softwares	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Core voltage adjustment	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Freq adjustment	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Component layout on the motherboard (S05)**	2.17	2.00	2.67	2.17	2.33	1.17
Package contents						
Manual / CDs	✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓	✓ / ✓
Necessary cables provided	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Gaming Benchmarks: Serious Sam Second Encounter						
Average fps	20.83	17.80	24.70	16.13	Failed	27.63
Quake III Arena						
Average fps	26.53	24.53	39.17	26.60	38.23	35.43
Real world Test						
ZDbench Content Creation 2004	18.5	17.8	23.1	18.5	21.7	21.5
ZDbench Business Winstone 2004	14.6	13.6	21.8	14.3	19.3	20.2
Video Encoding (Time in secs)	125	133	89	118	88	91
Synthetic Benchmarks						
3D Mark 2001 SE (patched- for onboard without AGP slot)	569	522	1,367	624	1,426	1,403
PC Mark 2004						
CPU Index	3,072	1,295	2,024	3,111	2,056	3,388
Memory Index	1,336	3,495	3,382	1,521	2,971	1,962
Graphics	218	2,997	3,406	218	3,441	400
Disk Index	3,483	206	400	2,943	434	2,967
Total Score	2,168	2,070	2,560	2,210	2,715	2,555
Sisoft Sandra 2004 Professional: CPU sub-system						
CPU Dhrystone / Whetstone	7,597 / 3,134	7,582 / 3,128	7,831 / 3,239	7,654 / 3,166	7,873 / 3,257	7,753 / 3,250
Multimedia - CPU Integer / FPU SSE	18,206 / 18,652	18,188 / 18,722	18,847 / 19,342	18,392 / 18,941	18,922 / 19,457	18,933 / 19,486
Memory sub-system						
ALU / RAM	884	871	2,040	1,191	1,998	1,665
FPU / RAM	870	853	1,948	1,147	1,901	1,668
Disk drive						
Drive Index MBps	26,225	26,355	25,655	19,716	19,110	20,700
Performance	33.40	32.03	43.99	33.55	41.10	41.81
Features	11.37	10.30	14.07	11.37	13.93	13.47
Performance + Features	44.77	42.33	58.06	44.92	55.04	55.28
VFM	11.19	9.41	13.50	14.49	12.23	16.50
Price (Rs)	4,000	4,500	4,300	3,100	4,500	3,350
Grade	C+	C-	B	B-	C+	D

**Scale of 5

In the synthetic tests, the results were similar. The PCMark 2004 test results clearly shows it all. As expected, the memory scores for boards with the KM266 chipset were the lowest. In second place were the KM400 boards, while the nForce2 boards won the top spot.

Similarly, in 3DMark 2001 SE, the graphics scores were really low for the KM266 boards. They got better to a certain extent on the KM400 boards, and then shot up for the nForce2 Krypton board. This clearly made the Krypton C18G-400 a winner in this bunch of mother-

For a mere Rs 2,850, you get the impressive Mercury KT400FDSX—graphics card extra, of course



boards.

We then compared the Krypton C18G-400 with the other two boards—the Mercury KT400FDSX and the Krypton NF2400U. The graphics score was the only parameter that was calculated with the insertion of the graphics card. Let's have a quick look at what turned up.

In Serious Sam 2, it was the Krypton NF2400U that was ahead of the two boards.